MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, 5.56MM, BALL, (HEAVY BULLET) REFERENCE

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, (Heavy Bullet) Reference to be used for calibrating, proof testing, and inspecting equipment for the performance tests of the Cartridge, 5.56mm, Ball, M855, and Cartridge, 5.56mm, Tracer, M856.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-002550 - Ammunition, General Specification for
MIL-A-48078 - Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification for

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspections of Attributes

FSC 1305

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, Attn. DRSMC-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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MIL-STD-636	-	Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition Through Caliber .50
MIL-STD-644	-	Visual Inspection Standards andInspection Procedures for Inspection of Packaging, Packing and Marking of Small Arms Ammunition
MIL-STD-1168	-	Lot Numbering of Ammunition

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

DRAWINGS

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CENTER (ARDC)

9357841	-	Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball Reference
7643674	-	Classification of Cartridge Case Defects for Small Arms Ammunition
P9357841	-	Packaging and Marking, Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, (Heavy Bullet) Reference, Cartons, Box, Ammunition, M2A1, Box, Wirebound
LI-9357841	-	Index of Inspection Equipment Lists for Cartridge

PUBLICATIONS

SCATP-5.56mm (Heavy Bullet)	-	Small Caliber Ammunition Test Procedures for 5.56mm (Heavy Bullet) Cartridges

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

Title 49 - Transportation, Parts 100-199

(The Code of Federal Regulations is available from the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. Orders should specifiy, "49 CFR 100-199 (latest revision)").

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Cartridge. The cartridge shall comply with all requirements specified on Dwg. 9357841, all associated drawings, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications. See also Section 6 (Uniformity of charge).

3.3 Bullet extraction. The force necessary to extract the bullet from the cartridge case shall be not less than 45 pounds.

3.4 Residual stress. The cartridge case shall not split when subjected to one percent mercurous nitrate solution for 15 minutes.

3.5 Waterproofness. The cartridge shall not release more than one bubble of air when subjected to a positive internal pressure of 7.5 pounds per square inch (psi) for 30 seconds.

3.6 Velocity. The average velocity of the cartridges when conditioned at 70° + 2° Fahrenheit (F) shall be 3000 feet per second plus or minus 40 feet per second at 78 feet from the muzzle of the weapon. The standard deviation of the velocities shall not exceed 20 ft/sec.

3.7 Chamber pressure. The average chamber pressure of the sample cartridges, conditioned at 70° + 2°F shall not exceed 55,000 psi. Neither the chamber pressure of an individual sample test cartridge or the average chamber pressure plus three standard deviations of chamber pressure shall exceed 61,000 psi. The standard deviation shall not exceed 1900 psi.

3.8 Port pressure. The mean port pressure minus three standard deviations of port pressure shall not be less than 13,000 psi for sample cartridges conditioned to 70° ± 2°F.

3.9 Accuracy. The average horizontal and vertical linear standard deviations of the sample cartridges shall not exceed 6.0 inches when fired at a range of 600 yards. No individual target shall exhibit horizontal or vertical linear standard deviations greater than 7.8 inches at 600 yards.

3.10 Matching. The mean point of impact of the test cartridges at 600 yards shall not deviate above or below the mean point of impact of the NATO Reference Round in a vertical direction, by more than 6 inches.

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* 3.11 Action time. The mean action time plus five standard deviations shall not exceed 3 milliseconds. Action time is defined as the sum of the primer ignition time, propellant burning time, and the time taken by the bullet to reach the gas port.

3.12 Function and casualty. The cartridge shall function without casualty.

3.13 Workmanship. The requirements for workmanship shall be as specified on applicable drawings, referenced specifications and in accordance with the following:

a. Metal defects. The cartridge shall be free of metal defects which include, but are not limited to; folds, wrinkles, scratches, scaly metal, dents perforations, splits, and other discontinuities.

b. Foreign matter. The cartridge shall be free of corrosions, stains, discolorations, dirt, and smears of lacquer.

c. Cleaning. Cleaning methods used shall not be injurious to any part, nor shall the parts be contaminated by any cleaning agent.

d. Contamination of explosive components. Extreme care shall be exercised to avoid contamination of primers and propellant by oil, grease, or other foreign matter.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

* 4.1.1 Inspection equipment. In accordance with MIL-A-48078 (Inspection Equipment) and MIL-A-002550 (Test and measuring equipment).

4.1.2 Classification of inspections. The following type of inspection shall apply: Quality Conformance Inspection

4.2 Quality Conformance Inspection

4.2.1 Lot formation. In accordance with MIL-A-48078.

4.2.1.1 Lot submission. The product shall be submitted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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4.2.1.2 Component parts. Unless otherwise specified, component lots shall be homogeneous and of a size convenient to the contractor and inspected, tested and accepted by the contractor. The cartridge lot may not contain:

a. Cartridge cases from more than one manufacturer.

b. Primers from more than one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

c. Bullets from more than one interfix number from one manufacturer.

d. Propellant from not more than one lot and not more than one manufacturer.

4.2.1.3 Lot identification. Each lot of ammunition shall be identified as to type, caliber and model, as well as a lot number in accordance with MIL-STD-1168.

4.2.2 Examination for defects.

a. Major and minor defects - Examintion for major and minor defects shall be performed on a class basis in accordance with classification of defects using applicable sampling plans and acceptance criteria of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level (AQL) for the major class shall be 0.25 percent and the AQL for the minor class shall be 1.50 percent. All non-conforming cartridges shall be rejected.

b. Critical defects - Unless otherwise specified, one hundred percent examination shall be performed for all critical defects. If a visual critical defect is found in a sample either just prior to a firing test or after a firing test (and the defect is not due to the firing), the lot shall be rejected. The lot shall then be rescreened and resubmitted for visual inspecton of critical defects. If a critical defect is found during packing, the portion of the lot that has been packed or is in the process of being packed shall be rejected. In addition, the portion of the lot remaining to be packed shall be rejected. The lot shall then be rescreened and resubmitted for visual inspection of critical defects.

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PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 3		DRAWING NUMBER
4.2.2.1	Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, M855 (Heavy Bullet) Reference				9357841
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical			100%		
1.	Perforated Case (6)			3.1	Visual
2.	Case split in K, L or M location (7)			3.1	Visual
3.	Primer missing (32)			3.1	Visual
4.	Primer cocked (33)			3.1	Visual
5.	Primer inverted (34)			3.1	Visual
6.	Weight min 1/			3.1	Balance
Major	(Group AQL - .25%)				
101.	Total length			3.1	Gage
102.	Case split in I, S, or J location (6)			3.1	Visual
103.	Corrosion or stain with etching (2)			3.1	Visual
104.	Chamfer missing on head (rim) (13)			3.1	Visual
	1/ Each lightweight cartridge shall be disassembled and the propellant weighted. Any cartridge containing less than 13 grains of propellant shall be classed as a critical defect. Any cartridge containing 13 grains or more of propellant shall be classed as a major defect.				
	Numbers after defect descriptions refer to visual defect standards in MIL-STD-636 (NATO Caliber 7.62mm Section).				

NOTES:

DRSMC-QA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 3	DRAWING NUMBER 9357841
4.2.2.1	Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, M855 (Heavy Bullet) Reference			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY Not applicable
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH / PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
105.	Case mouth not crimped in cannelure (11)			3.1 Visual
106.	No evidence of mouth anneal (21)			3.1 Visual
107.	Draw scratch (8)			3.1 Visual
108.	Split bullet jacket (24)			3.1 Visual
109.	Loose bullet (25)			3.1 Visual
110.	Loose primer (35)			3.1 Visual
111.	Scaly metal (12)			3.1 Visual
112.	Profile and alignment			3.1 Gage
113.	Diameter of head			3.1 Gage
114.	Thickness of head			3.1 Gage
115.	Length to shoulder datum diameter			3.1 Gage
116.	Depth of primer			3.1 Gage
117.	Diameter of extractor groove, max			3.1 Gage
118.	Nato mark missing			3.1 Visual

NOTES: Numbers after defect descriptions refer to visual defect standards in MIL-STD-636 (NATO Caliber 7.62mm Section).

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PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 3 OF 3		DRAWING NUMBER
4.2.2.1	Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, M855 (Heavy Bullet) Reference				9357841
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
					Not applicable
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Minor	(Group AQL - 1.5%)				
201.	Discolored, dirty, oily, or smeared (1)			3.1	Visual
202.	Case dented (5)			3.1	Visual
203.	Scaly metal on case (12)			3.1	Visual
204.	Fold, wrinkle, buckle or bulge in case (14, 15, 16, 17)			3.1	Visual
205.	Head stamp missing or illegible (18)			3.1	Visual
206.	Defective head (19)			3.1	Visual
207.	Defective mouth (20)			3.1	Visual
208.	Bullet dented (22)			3.1	Visual
209.	Bullet scratched (23)			3.1	Visual
210.	Scaly metal on bullet (27)			3.1	Visual
211.	Upset (crooked) point (28)			3.1	Visual
212.	Blunt point (30)			3.1	Visual
213.	Defective cannelure (31)			3.1	Visual
214.	Nicked or dented primer (36)			3.1	Visual
215.	No waterproofing material (primer pocket joint) (37)			3.1	Visual
				3.1	Visual
216.	Defective crimp (28)			3.1	Visual
217.	Scratch (case) (9)			3.1	Visual
218.	Missing or improper color of bullet tip			3.1	Visual
219.	Extractor groove diameter undersized			3.1	Gage

NOTES: Numbers after defect descriptions refer to visual defect standards in MIL-STD-636 (NATO Caliber 7.62mm Section).

DRSMC-QA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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4.2.3 Testing. Testing is described in the Quality Conformance Inspection tables (4.2.3.1). Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the methods and procedures specified in 4.3.

a. Test samples. The quantities for the various tests shall be as specified in paragraph 4.2.3.1. Only cartridges having met the visual and dimensional requirements shall be used in the ballistic tests, and shall have been selected in such a manner that the sample is representative of the entire lot. Sufficient cartridges shall be selected such that all testing (including testing of second samples where applicable) can be performed. The cartridges shall be thoroughly mixed before being divided into samples for the various tests.

b. Firing defects and associated acceptance-rejection criteria are specified in Table I.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER
4.2.3.1	Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, (Heavy Bullet) Reference				9357841
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	TESTS				
*	Bullet extraction	25	0-3		
		75	2-3	3.3	4.3.2
	Residual stress	50	0-2		
		150	1-2	3.4	4.3.2
	Waterproofness	50	3-10		
		150	9-10	3.5	4.3.2
*	Velocity 1/	300	2/	3.6	
*	Chamber pressure 1/	300	2/	3.7	
*	Port pressure 1/	300	2/	3.8	
*	Action time 1/	300	2/	3.11	
*	Accuracy 3/	450	2/	3.9	
	Matching 4/	90	2/	3.10	
*	Function and casualty 5/	750	6/	3.12	

NOTES:

DRSMC-OA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-70460A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER 9357841
4.2.3.1	Cartridge, 5.56MM, Ball, (Heavy Bullet) Reference				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
*	1/ Velocity, chamber pressure, port pressure, and action time shall be tested simultaneously - (EPVAT). One hundred rounds tested for 3 consecutive days.				
	2/ Failure of the cartridges to comply with the applicable requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.				
*	3/ Five thirty round targets for three consecutive days. Each day, one round is permitted to miss only one of the three targets. Two or more misses out of three valid targets shall result in rejection of the lot. See SCATP-5.56mm (Heavy Bullet) for definition of "valid target".				
	4/ One thirty round target per day from the accuracy test may be used as the sample for this test.				
	5/ Samples for F&C shall be the samples from the EPVAT and Accuracy test.				
	6/ See Table I for defect classification and accept/ reject criteria.				
NOTES:					

DPSMC-OA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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TABLE I

Firing defect classification and accept-reject criteria 4/

Defect Class	Defect Description	ACC	REJ
Critical	Bullet in bore	0	1
Critical	Misfire - No vent hole	0	1
Major	Misfire - other causes 2/	1	2
Major	Failure to extract	0	1
Major	Other 5/	0	1
	Primer Failures		
Major	a. Perforation of firing pin ident in primer cup	1	2
Major	b. Escape of gas through primer cup (excluding a above	1	2
Major	c. Loose primer 3/	1	2
Major	d. Blown primer 3/	0	1
Major	e. Dropped primer 3/	0	1
Major	f. Escape of gas around primer cup		
	1. 50% or more than 50% of periphery	5	6
	2. Less than 50% or periphery	10	11
	Case Casualties 1/		
1. Longitudinal split			
Major	a. Body (J)	1	2

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Major	b. Body (K)	0	1
Major	c. to head (L)	0	1
Major	d. Through head (M)	0	1
Minor	e. Neck and shoulder (I or S)	10	11

II. Circumferential Rupture

Major	a. Partial, shoulder or body (J & S)	0	1
Major	b. Partial, body (K)	0	1
Major	c. Partial, head (L)	0	1
Major	d. Complete	0	1

Note 1/ For location of defects indicated by letters in parenthesis, see Drawing 7643674.

Note 2/ Each cartridge that misfires shall be disassembled and examined for presence of vent holes. If the vent hole is missing the lot shall be rejected.

Note 3/ Primer Defect Description

a. Loose primer. Looseness, but not so as to permit the fired primer to fall from the primer pocket. The fired primer shall be called loose when it protrudes above the case head or movement of the primer can be observed by applying pressure on the primer by means of a probe, thumbnail or fingertip.

b. Blownprimer. A primer which, when the cartridge is fired, is separated completely from the head of the cartridge case, and both the head of the case and the primer pocket are grossly distorted and deformed. The severity of this condition is such that it is readily detectable with the naked eye.

c. Dropped primer. A primer which falls from the primer pocket after the cartridge is fired.

Note 4/ If defects are encountered, the test barrels shall be examined for proper functioning and repaired or replaced. The type of defect(s) which occurred shall be judged as caused by the test barrel or ammunition. If the defects are attributed to the test barrel then the test shall be disregarded and repeated for that test barrel.

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Note 5/ All stoppages attributable to the ammunition, with the exception of misfire, complete rupture or failure to extract, observed in the tests shall be included.

4.2.4 Packaging, packing, and marking. Inspection for packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-644. During or immediately prior to the packaging operation, 100 percent examination of the cartridges shall be performed to ascertain that the cartridge type conforms to the drawing. Occurrence of a high pressure test cartridge shall be classed as a critical defect. Occurrence of any incorrect type other than high pressure test shall be classed as a major defect. All non-conforming cartridges shall be rejected.

4.2.5 Inspection equipment. The inspection equipment required to perform the examination and test prescribed herein is described in the Paragraph Reference/Inspection method column in the tables starting with Paragraph 4.2.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.2 herein.

4.2.5.1 Index of inspection equipment list. The examination tests shall be made using equipment listed on LI-9357841.

4.3 Methods of inspection.

4.3.1 Materials, components, and processes. Compliance with all requirements of Section 3 of this specification shall be ascertained by current and continuing examination of inspection and test data to determine that all components (parts, subassemblies and materials) have been inspected and tested and found to comply with their respective drawing and specification requirements, and that all specified manufacturing processes have been followed.

4.3.1.1 Visual and mechanical inspections. The visual, manual and mechanical inspections and tests shall verify compliance with the requirements of Sections 3 and 5 of this specification in accordance with 4.2.2 and 4.2.4 herein.

4.3.2 Acceptance test. All tests shall be performed as specified in SCATP-5.56MM (Heavy Bullet).

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing - level A (worldwide shipment). The cartridges shall be packed in accordance with the applicable drawings cited in Section 2, and in accordance with Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, Parts 100-199.

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5.2 Marking and labeling. Marking and labeling of the packed cartridges shall be in accordance with applicable drawings cited in Section 2, and in accordance with Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, Parts 100-199.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cartridges covered by this specification are intended for use as reference cartridges for calibration purposes in 5.56MM proof testing equipment.

6.2 Ordering data. Ordering data should include:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Type and level of packing for the cartridges.

c. Provisions for the submission of Inspection Equipment Designs (DI-R-1714).

d. Provision for submission of detailed inspection plan for the cartridge (DI-R-4803) (see 6.7).

e. Provisions for the submission of acceptance inspection reports containing final inspection results for each lot of ammunition presented to the Government (see 6.6).

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. (See MIL-A-48078). Submit inspection equipment designs as required to Commander, ARDC, ATTN: AMSMC-QAF-I(D), Dover, NJ 07801-5001.

6.4 Hazard notice. The cartridge described herein and some of its components are flammable and explosive and consequently present hazards in manufacture, handling, storage and shipment. The contractor should recognize these hazards and take appropriate measures to prevent fire, explosion, adverse environment, rough handling, corrosive atmosphere, and electrically inducted incidents. Such measures shall include the employment of an effective safety program that addresses the inherent hazards associated with the cartridge.

6.5 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research and Development Center (ARDC) may also include drawing prepared by, and identified as Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal, US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM) or Picatinny Arsenal drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under the cognizance of ARDC.

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6.6 Submission of test data. In addition to the normal distribution of records, when the cartridge is procured by the US AMCCOM, on (1) copy of all ballistic data and the ammunition data card for each lot shall be forwarded to: Commander, ARDC, ATTN: AMSMC-QAF-S(D), Dover, NJ 07801-5001.

6.7 Uniformity of charge. A machine shall be chosen which is known to drop charges with better than average uniformity and which gives constant results in the daily production tests. If relative machine performance is unknown, special tests should be fired to assure selection of a good machine.

6.7.1 Loading control. A quantity of 20 rounds shall be fired for pressure and velocity for each four hours of an eight hour shift to establish velocity and pressure values, and check charge weight and uniformity of charge weight every hour.

6.8 Changes from previous issues. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the previous issue.

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing Activity:
Army-AR

(Project 1305-AB18)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-70460A	CARTRIDGE, 5.56MM, BALL (HEAVY BULLET) REFERENCE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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